Jay Stewart

Software engineer. Eight years before AI; now building and running production software with coding agents.

● Open to remote roles, contract or permanent

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PROFILE

Eight years of backend and full-stack engineering before AI: PHP, Laravel, Magento, MySQL, JavaScript, Linux. Since March 2026 I build and run SpiralClass in production with coding agents: real payments, live video with translated captions, and an LLM pipeline that turns each class into learning notes the teacher checks. Most of the code is agent-written; I review it, test it and run it. Looking for a remote, hybrid or on-site role, contract or permanent. Based in the UK, abroad for now; back within days for a UK role. Contractor through Deel or Remote or as a UK sole trader; permanent through Deel or Remote, or direct once I'm back.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer (independent)

Mar 2026 – now

SpiralClass `live · real payments` Booking, payments and video for independent teachers. Built and run solo.

- Stripe Connect direct charges: the teacher is merchant of record; the platform never holds funds.
- Live captions translated in class: browser speech recognition, Deepgram for phones, on-device or Google translation. Recognition runs in the browser, so no server of mine handles the audio.
- Post-class LLM pipeline: Claude with forced tool calls and zod-validated output turns the transcript into findings the teacher confirms before they count. Consent-gated; models split by call shape for cost.
- Next.js, Postgres (82 models), LiveKit video. About 880 test files behind one merge gate. 146 decision records.

Career break

Sep 2020 – Mar 2026

A planned break, travelling on savings, with AI as a hobby. Back in March 2026, once coding agents could build whole apps end to end; I keep only what gets real use, and SpiralClass is the one in production.

Full Stack Developer · Thrive Chiropractic (contract, remote)

Aug 2016 – Aug 2020

- Sole developer of their booking and payments platform in Laravel, PHP and MySQL, from requirements with the practice to running it for four years, alongside agency work.

Backend Engineer · G&V | Venture Brands Agency (contract) · Bristol

Jul 2017 – Mar 2020

- Dyson's high-traffic Magento 2 stores, mainly Dyson India, in a team of about five. Built the "Book a demo" module; fixed production issues where an outage meant lost orders.

Backend Engineer · We Are Folk (then Folk Digital) · Poole · Magento, luxury fashion

Jul 2014 – Aug 2016

Full Stack Developer · C3 Commerce (then C3 Media) · Bristol · Magento, from junior

Jul 2012 – Jul 2014

HOW I WORK

- **Care about money and production.** Payments reconcile to the right person; rules are tested against a real database.
- **Write things down.** A short update each day; decisions live in the pull request or issue.

SKILLS

SpiralClass runs on	TypeScript, Next.js, React, Tailwind, Postgres (Neon), Prisma, Inngest, LiveKit
AI engineering	Claude API, structured outputs, prompt tests, Deepgram, Google speech and translation, Claude Code, Codex
Testing	Vitest, Playwright, visual regression, GitHub Actions, CodeQL
Payments and ops	Stripe Connect, Wise; Docker, Cloud Run, Cloudflare R2, OpenTofu, Sentry, PostHog
Languages	English (native), Spanish (conversational)